Theme 2: Starting University

A Helping Hand (Asking for clarification)

Lesson 2-4
Book pages 24-25

💡 **Big idea:** The **SQU Rovers** help new students at Sultan Qaboos University. We listen for specific information and learn phrases to **ask for, check and confirm clarification**.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Listen for specific information
- Identify common problems of new students
- Ask for clarification politely
- Check and confirm understanding

📖 Key words

clarification توضيح	**placement test** اختبار تحديد المستوى	**Foundation Programme** البرنامج التأسيسي
co-ordinator منسق	**volunteer** متطوع	**supervisor** مشرف

The SQU Rovers

- An active group of students in different years at SQU
- Over 100 male and over 30 female Rovers
- They organise activities and trips throughout the year
- At the start of the first semester they help new students on the Foundation Programme
- New students' problems: managing on their own, finding the way around, missing family, finding rooms

Soundbites: clarification

- Asking: Can you tell me...? / I'm not clear what... / Do you mean...? / Could you explain...? / I'm not sure I follow you.
- Checking: Are you with me? / Are you clear about...?
- Confirming: Thanks, I'm clear now. / Yes, I see. / I understand. / Got it!



Soundbites: asking for clarification (p.25)

✏️ Examples

You don't understand the word 'placement test'. Ask politely.

Answer: Could you explain what a placement test is?

Confirm that you understood.

Answer: Thanks, I'm clear now.

⭐ Remember

- 'Could you explain...?' is more polite than 'What?'

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ Can you tell me where is it? ✓ Can you tell me where it is?

🧩 **Activity:** Explain the rules of a game to your partner

✅ Check yourself

1. Who are the SQU Rovers?
2. Phrase to check understanding
3. Phrase to confirm
4. What is a placement test?

Answers: (1) a group of students who help others and organise activities ، (2) Are you with me? ، (3) Got it! ، (4) an exam to find a student's level